

HUMAN ARCHITECT · OWL

THE CLOSING FIELD MANUAL

A forensic training manual for selling managed AI employees. Scripts, objections, proof, roles, and close sequences.

Teach the model. Close the deal. Own the loop.

Internal training · VERIFIED 2026-07-29 · For operators only

Live: <https://alkali.humanarchitect.github.io/ai-employee/>

Call: <https://beacons.ai/humanarchitect>

Operators close. Agents fulfill.

This manual is not theory. It is a repeatable closing system for a £5,000/month managed AI employee offer. You either teach it or you outsource it. Never let the client feel the difference.

Rule one: the client does not buy AI. They buy a removed burden. Lead with the burden, not the technology.

Every stage below is mapped to owner power and agent support. The owner owns the relationship and the close. The agent owns the follow-up, the proof, and the admin. If you mix these roles on a call, you lose leverage.

“You brief. The agent delivers. The client keeps their result.”

How to think during the close

The client is not saying no. They are calculating risk. Lower the risk faster than they can raise it.

- • **You are not selling software.** You are selling a managed outcome. The price follows the outcome, not the tooling.
 - • **Speed beats perfection.** The first operator to show up with a credible plan wins. Credibility comes from specificity, not polish.
 - • **Objections are requests for reassurance,** not rejection. Answer the fear behind the sentence, not the sentence itself.
 - • **Close is not a moment.** It is a sequence. Discovery → fit → proof → terms → next step.
 - • **The agent is your leverage, not your sales pitch.** Say: 'I have a build system.' Do not say: 'the agent builds itself.'
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ROLES

Owner vs agent during the sale

Clear role split prevents confusion and protects trust.

Owner does	Agent does	Client sees
Discovery calls	Follow-up emails	Fast, personal replies
Price framing + close	Proof assembly + case-drop calendar	Consistent evidence
Scoping conversation	Knowledge-base intake forms	Structured intake without rework
Live demo or workflow review	Health checks + readiness tests	Reliable delivery timeline
Objection handling	Objection handler library + snippets	Confident answers in chat/email
Relationship ownership	Appointment scheduling + reminders	No dropped balls

If the client ever hears the term 'automated' as a reason to trust you less, you are describing the agent badly. Say 'managed system' or 'delivery layer'.

Discovery call script

1 · Opener

'Thanks for making the time. The goal of this call is simple: find out whether there is a clear, painful task we can take off your plate in 48 hours. I will do less talking than you.'

2 · Pain discovery

'What task costs your team two or more hours every single day?'

'What happens when that task slips?'

'Who currently owns it, and what are they not doing because of it?'

'If this was handled 24/7 without you managing it, what would that unlock next month?'

3 · Fit

'Based on what you just said, I can see one agent that fits: [exact task]. It would live in your Slack, handle [workflow], and report to [owner/channel].'

'Price is flat £5,000/month. Managed, unlimited, by day two. Does that feel worth solving, given what you just described?'

4 · Close

'I can send onboarding instructions today. We will have a live demo by [day]. Shall I set it up?'

How to prove it without bragging

Clients do not need more evidence. They need the right evidence, at the right moment, in their language.

- • **Anchor with the model first**, not your CV. 'Operators are running this at £5k/month with one person.'
- • **Then drop one relevant case**. Pick the sector closest to theirs. Barbershop? Lead with Boon Media barber metrics. SaaS? Lead with B2B SaaS support metrics.
- • **Then show the stack**. One slide. One architecture sentence: 'Orchestrator plus sub-agents, Slack-native, self-hosted.'
- • **Then show the calendar**. 'Day one: signed agreement. Day two: live agent.' That is the close.

Rule: never show more than three proof points per call. More evidence weakens certainty, not strengthens it.

DEMO

The 20-minute live demo script

Setup

Open a clean Slack workspace or dedicated Telegram thread so the client sees the agent from inside their own tool. No custom UI, no login portals.

Minute 0–5 · The brief

'Here is the exact workflow we scoped on the call. The agent owns [task]. It reads from [knowledge folder]. It answers in [Slack/Telegram]. Here is how it starts.'

Minute 5–15 · Live execution

Send a real inbound message the agent should handle. Let it respond. Show the knowledge base. Show the fallback behaviour when it does not know.

Minute 15–20 · What you own

'This is live now. You will see health alerts here. I will handle improvements. You handle the client relationship. If it misses the agreed target by day 30, partial refund.'

Do not demo features. Demo outcome. Every minute should show ownership, not capability.

The 5-step close

1 · Summary

Repeat what they asked for using their words. 'You want a support agent in Slack that closes customer tickets without you in the middle.'

2 · Investment

'Flat £5,000/month. Managed. Unlimited usage. Live by day two. Partial refund if it misses the target by day 30.'

3 · Risk reversal

'I do not need a long-term commitment. Start with one agent, one workflow. If it does not earn its keep by day 30, we will make it right.'

4 · Next step

'I will send onboarding instructions and a simple intake form. You wire the first month. We start tomorrow.'

5 · Assumption close

'Great — does Tuesday or Wednesday work better for the scoping handoff?'

If they hesitate on price, return to pain value: 'What does that manual task cost you per month right now?'

OBJECTIONS

Field-tested handlers

Objection	Acknowledge	Handler	Close
It's too expensive	It feels steep if you compare it to a seat.	This is a managed employee on a flat fee, not a tool. If the task costs £2,400/month in human hours, this pays for itself before your first two bad hires.	What does that task cost you right now?
We can't do AI here	Most clients said the same.	The agent lives in Slack. You don't touch code. You watch the work get done.	Can we show you one workflow in 10 minutes?
We already have tools	Tools are not fulfillment.	A dashboard still needs someone to do the work. Owl ships the outcome.	What task is still manual even though you have tools?
We've used AI before	Past failure is useful data.	Most AI projects fail because they ship a toy, not a worker. We ship managed execution.	What broke last time — setup, tool, outcomes?
Too small	Size is relative to pain.	SMBs at £1M–£2M+ pay faster and ask fewer questions. They value outcomes over novelty.	What task costs you 2+ hours every day?
Not custom enough	Custom is expected.	Every agent is custom by default — built from your knowledge, workflow, outputs.	Can we scope exactly one role for your next call?
Will replace people	Workforce fear is real.	It replaces the manual work nobody wants to do. Your team moves to higher-value work.	What would your team do with 10 hours back?
Need to test first	Test mode is reasonable.	Start with one agent, one workflow. If it misses target by day 30, partial refund.	What is the one task you would test first?
Data is sensitive	Security concern is valid.	Your data stays within your environment. Controlled scope, not blanket access.	Do you have a data policy we should align with?
Need HR approval	Good — HR protects the team.	This is an external supplier system, not an internal hire.	Can HR join the scoping call?
Not a priority right now	Priority follows pain.	One painful task is stealing margin and attention right now.	What task would free you up to focus on growth?
Need to think about it	Think is stall.	The only risk is inaction. Margin bleeds while you wait. I will follow up Thursday.	What would help you decide by Thursday?

How to run a live close

A live deal is a pipeline with timestamps and ownership. Do not let a prospect float in 'we are thinking about it' forever.

- • **Hour 0:** discovery call → scoping handoff email within 30 minutes.
- • **Hour 1–4:** agent sends intake form; owner sends case-study PDF matching their sector.
- • **Hour 4–24:** agent schedules the follow-up call; owner reviews intake and drafts agent brief.
- • **Day 2:** live demo or delivery preview with exact workflow.
- • **Day 3–7:** answer objections by email/Slack; keep proof in sight.
- • **Day 7:** close or clear decision. If not closed, reduce price or scope, or move prospect to nurture for 14 days.

Do not extend hope without a defined decision. A deal without a next step is not a deal.

DEMO

Demo techniques that convert

A demo is not a tour. It is a promise you keep in real time.

- • **Start with pain**, not features: 'You described follow-up dropping off after day three. Here is the exact sequence your agent will own.'
 - • **Use real data**, not synthetic examples: import one anonymised client message or ticket.
 - • **Show failure mode first**: ask the agent a question it cannot answer. Show the fallback. This builds trust faster than perfection.
 - • **End on outcome**, not roadmap: 'This is live on day two. You get the first complete set of results by Friday.'
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How to negotiate without discounting

Discount is a last resort. Change scope or value first.

- • **Scope down, not price:** one agent, one workflow, 30-day start.
 - • **Payment cadence:** monthly first, then quarterly with a small discount only after 90 days.
 - • **Guarantee leverage:** 'I can offer a partial refund by day 30 if we miss the agreed target. That protects you without devaluing the work.'
 - • **Add outcome terms:** specific target, milestone, or SLA attached to performance.
 - • **Framing:** 'This is priced for managed execution, not access. The alternative is hiring, which costs more and never guarantees outcome.'
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Scripts you can copy

Post-call follow-up

'Quick recap: we scoped [agent name] to own [task] inside [Slack/Telegram]. Flat £5,000/month, managed, live by day two. Partial refund if we miss the target by day 30. I will send onboarding instructions and the intake form by 6pm GMT. Reply with the best scoping time for tomorrow and I will lock it in.'

Proof drop

'This case matches your sector: [sector]. Before/after metrics: [metric] to [metric]. The client now runs the agent solo with a 30-minute weekly review.'

Re-engagement nurture

'Still thinking about it. If the blocker is budget, we can start with one workflow at reduced scope and expand once it earns its keep. If it is trust, I can send a signed NDA and a 14-day pilot plan. What would help most?'

METRICS

Measure what matters

Track these every week until the model is proven.

Metric	Target	Why it matters
Discovery calls/week	5+	Top of funnel.
Audit-to-agent rate	20%+	Quality of fit.
Close rate	15%+	Conversion strength.
Day-two live rate	90%+	Speed-to-value.
Client NPS / testimonial rate	1 per 3 clients	Proof compounding.
Time to first value	<7 days	Retention predictor.

If discovery calls are high but closes are low, fix the offer or the proof sequence. Do not increase traffic.

Your first 30 days

- • Day 1: publish one post on the Fulfillment Layer. Post one thread. Send five outreach messages.
- • Day 2–7: complete five discovery calls using the script in this manual.
- • Day 7: close one £999 audit. Build agent brief in your clients folder.
- • Day 8–14: ship first live agent. Collect before/after metrics.
- • Day 15–21: record a case study from the first client. Publish again.
- • Day 22–30: raise price or scope once you have one proven outcome. Add sub-agents for support, not more of you.

“Repeat until the model is proven. Then scale with systems, not yourself.”

